

# Foundations of Leadership: Palm Beach County's First Black Trailblazers

**Clarence E. Anthony:** Chief Executive Officer and Executive Director of the National League of Cities; former Mayor of South Bay.

**Verdenia C. Baker:** First Black woman to hold County Administrator position.

**Joseph Bernadel:** First Haitian American to found a public school in the U.S. (in Delray Beach).

**Mack Bernard:** First Black man of Haitian descent from Palm Beach County elected as FL State Representative, County Commissioner, and County Mayor (appointed).

**Louise E. Buie:** Led efforts to ensure Black history and contributions were added to previously all-White textbooks in the Palm Beach County School District.

**Edith Bush:** Executive Director of the Martin Luther King Jr. Coordinating Committee.

**Maxine Cheesman:** First Black Jamaican woman to be elected as a Circuit Court Judge.

**F. Malcolm Cunningham, Sr.:** Opened the first Black law practice in West Palm Beach and founded the first minority-owned commercial bank in Florida.

**Reginald Duren:** First Black Palm Beach County Fire Rescue Chief.

**John Russell Dyett:** Built first Black maternity hospital.

**Vera Farrington:** Founder of Spady Cultural Heritage Museum.

**Dr. Donald Fenney:** First Black Superintendent of the Palm Beach County School District.

**Clinton B. Forbes:** First Black Palm Beach County Palm Tran Transportation Director.

**Maude Ford Lee:** First Black female Palm Beach County Commissioner.

**Dr. Dennis P. Gallon:** First Black president of Palm Beach State College.

**Mildred W. Gildersleeve:** First Black nurse midwife in Palm Beach County.

**Bernice Gordon Greene:** First Black Supervisor for Negro Education and Schools.

**Addie L. Greene:** First Black woman from Palm Beach County elected as FL State Representative.

**Bradley Harper:** First Black man elected as a Circuit Court Judge.

**James "Hank" Harper, Jr.:** First Black man from Palm Beach County elected as FL State Representative.

**Alcee Hastings:** First Black man from Florida to serve in Congress.

**Daniel Hendrix:** First Black man elected to the School Board of Palm Beach County.

**William M. Holland, Sr.:** Palm Beach County's first Black lawyer and a civil rights activist.

**Ineria E. Hudnell:** School teacher and historian of the Black history in Palm Beach County.

**Dr. Thomas L. Jefferson:** First Black physician in West Palm Beach.

**Eva Williams Mack:** First health specialist for the Palm Beach County School Board.

**Dr. Ava L. Parker:** First Black woman president of Palm Beach State College.

**C. Spencer Pompey:** Teacher, principal, author, and founder of the Palm Beach County Teacher's Association for Black Educators.

**Cashus W. Richardson, II:** First Black to manage a business in the Guaranty Building in WPB for the federal government.

**David L. Ricks:** First Black Palm Beach County Engineer Director.

**Debra L. Robinson, MD:** Founding member and first chair of the Coalition of Black Student Achievement.

**Edward Rodgers:** First Black judge in Palm Beach County.

**Edna W. Runner:** Founder of Runner Tutorial Center for students in Limestone Creek.

**Britton G. Sayles:** First Black college president in Palm Beach County.

**Solomon D. Spady:** Black educator and community leader in Delray Beach.

**Priscilla A. Taylor:** First Black woman mayor of Palm Beach County.

**Daisy T. Washington:** First Black woman postmaster.